

AI PROMPT ENGINEERING

Complete RCTTCE prompt

1. **ROLE:** Act as a senior data analyst with 7 years of experience.
2. **CONTEXT:** A retail company operates 30 stores and has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. The dataset provided contains approximately 50,000 records covering: Store performance, Product sales, Customer transactions, Loyalty programme activity.
3. **TASK:** Investigate 5 things causing declining performance and identify opportunities for improvement.
4. **FORMAT:** Numbered list. For each question include:
 - a. the question
 - b. why it matters to the CEO
 - c. which columns to use.
5. **TARGET AUDIENCE:** The CEO and other stakeholders
6. **CONSTRAINT:** Use only the information provided. No vague questions and statistical jargons
7. **EXAMPLE:** What is the revenue-per-transaction by store for the last 6 months

STAKEHOLDER BRIEF — CEO & EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

Retail Performance Diagnostic Analysis

Scope: 30 Stores

18 Months

50,000 Records

June 2026

1. SITUATION SUMMARY

The business has experienced sustained revenue decline across its 30-store network over the past 18 months. Early indicators point to a combination of falling customer visit frequency, lower spend per transaction, and weakening product performance — though the root causes appear to vary by store and location. This analysis is designed to isolate the specific drivers of decline and surface the highest-impact opportunities for recovery before the trend becomes irreversible.

2. THREE KEY BUSINESS QUESTIONS

Q1. Which stores are underperforming — and has their decline accelerated over the 18-month period?

All 30 stores will be ranked by revenue across three 6-month windows to identify chronic underperformers versus locations that were previously stable but have recently deteriorated.

Q2. Are customers spending less per visit, visiting less often, or both?

Visit frequency and average basket size will be separated to determine whether the business faces a customer traffic problem, an in-store experience problem, or both at the same time. The solution is entirely different depending on the answer.

Q3. Are new customers returning after their first purchase — and how does this compare to 18 months ago?

First-to-second purchase return rates will be measured to determine whether the business is losing customers at the retention stage. If new customers are not coming back, acquisition spending is effectively being wasted.

3. DECISIONS THESE QUESTIONS WILL INFORM

Whether to close, restructure, or increase investment in specific underperforming stores

Where to redirect the marketing budget — customer acquisition versus in-store conversion and retention

Whether the loyalty program needs to be redesigned to drive meaningful repeat behavior

Which product categories to prioritize, rationalize, or reprice

Whether the decline is a network-wide problem or concentrated in specific regions or store types

4. DESCRIPTION OF AVAILABLE DATA

The analysis draws on approximately 50,000 records across four data domains:

- Store Performance — Revenue, footfall, and location data across all 30 stores for the full 18-month period
- Product Sales — Units sold, product categories, pricing, and sales trends at individual product level
- Customer Transactions — Individual transaction records including date, store, basket value, and items purchased
- Loyalty Programme — Member versus non-member spend, points earned and redeemed, visit frequency, and enrollment trends over time.

REFLECTION ON WHY I STRUCTURE THE MY PROMT THE WAY I DID

I structured the prompt using clear labelled components - Role, Context, Task, Format, Target Audience, and Constraint because each one removes a different type of ambiguity that would otherwise produce a generic or unfocused response. Specifying the CEO and stakeholders as the audience forced the output to stay in plain business language rather than technical analyst-speak, and the example question anchored the format so the response matched the exact level of specificity needed. The constraint to avoid jargon was deliberate, because without it an AI will default to statistical language that loses non-technical executives.